



Mini Surface

Microsoft working on a smaller, 7 inch version of their tablet, Surface. <http://dgit.in/155Aggu>

Github turns five

It has been five years since Github made its first public debut. Github is where programmers come to share code and collaborate on open-source software. <http://dgit.in/Zba6ya>

Effects of Modafinil

Negative Effects

- Kinesthetic sense is sharper: Heightened senses also means a heightened sense of pain or injury.
- Vision is sharper: Colours are more vivid, which can also be distracting.
- Time flies: 5AM becomes 8PM without the user realising.
- Focussing on the wrong things: While it could increase focus, the target of that intense focus might be something like solving crosswords online.
- Loss of appetite: That's pretty self explanatory.
- Makes bad days worse: If the user is feeling low, it makes the user go deeper into that ill-feeling.

Looking ahead

Fast forward ten years or so, and considering that the drug has now been tweaked to perfection, now everyone is using Modafinil, or whatever it's called, at that time. Parents are being called for meetings because it has been discovered that their child is not performing well in class and after some investigation it has been found out that the child does not take modafinil pills. Arguments will break out online about how it is important to stay with the times and progress versus how one should only move ahead naturally. Sleep will be the refuge of the slackers, the poorer section of society will be unable to procure the drug and will fall behind, while the rich will get smarter



Try it. It might only cause paranoia, delusions, confusion...

Positive Effects

- Sleep obliterated: There is no need to sleep while on it, and after the drug the return to a 'normal' state does not take too long.
- No more lethargy: Tiredness is gone bringing with it a sharp and clear wakeful state.
- Connecting thoughts: Integrating creativity into logical thinking feels easier.
- Motivation: More energy and a better sense of well being.

Interestingly, two months after this post, Sebastian posted an update to his blog saying that he felt happier without Modafinil and that he feels he is not "built to work all the time".

and possibly even richer. We will be blatantly going against 'Pharmacological Calvinism' which believes that pain and suffering are integral aspects of what it means to be a human being and that drugs should only be used to treat illnesses and disease. Also, if the WADA banned the drug, why is it safe to use outside sports?

Well, that would be painting too bleak a picture, and there is no reason why we shouldn't also consider the other possibility. In this future, everyone is working at their full potential. Slacker is a term that was once used 'back in the day' and the rate of progress of everything has increased ten-fold. No-one simply occupies space on earth now - they do things.

A world of hyper-intelligent citizens racing ahead, a world where no work is mediocre. Overworked pilots will not fire missiles onto friendly forces, the novelist does not have to stare at his computer for months on end with not a word written, and lethargy will never be a reason for shoddy workmanship resulting in buildings crumbling. Fourth graders will argue about how Alice in Wonderland reveals Carroll's own repressed sexuality while on their way to a Calculus class. A rise of efficiency will occur, and this might very well be a good thing.

So why shouldn't I run out and get some Modafinil for myself?

Well, take a break from Modafinil for a bit and consider Viagra. Viagra was thought to be the cure for erectile dysfunction, it still is for some, but it isn't as simple as it seems. It will not just give an automatic erection as mental and tactile stimulation as well as foreplay are integral parts of arousal, and the reasons for erectile dysfunction are usually lifestyle choices — overeating, alcohol, drug abuse. Modafinil could be looked at in the same way. You are probably sleep-deprived because you were awake the whole night browsing 9gag. You are unmotivated because you are not sure of what to do ahead in life and you probably need to talk to someone who will understand. You are tired and have a head-ache because all the caffeine and dopamine rushes from the endless cigarettes or cups of tea and coffee is causing you to crash. In the end, you don't say no to the drug because it hurts your work ethics, you could intelligently say no to it because you think you can do better without it, and because you don't know how it will affect you years from now.

So, finally, is a smart drug better than a slap on the face?

Well, this is something we can't say for sure. They each have their place and whether the world decides to wake up or dope up is something that we can't decide for it. What would you rather believe in? Yourself or a drug? 10 years down the line, will you even have an option? 